



Cash-Drop/Closing Procedure Sheet

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Evidence Summary

This document was collected during the initial walk-through after the case was opened on **2026-05-11 at 08:42 (PT)**. It appears to be the diner's standardized instructions for cash drops and end-of-shift register handling.

Source / Location Found

The sheet was located taped to the inside of a cabinet door in the manager's office (rear hallway, adjacent to the kitchen). Staff indicated it is referenced during training and when a supervisor is correcting register practices.

Document Type and Appearance

Single-page, printed checklist titled ***"Cash Drop & Closing Routine (Overnight)"** with a footer line reading ***"Rev. 02/2026"**. The page shows coffee staining at the lower right corner and two handwritten notes in dark ink.

Core Procedure (Typed Text)

- **Cash Drop Timing:** "Perform cash drop at the top of each hour (01:00, 02:00, 03:00, 04:00) when possible; do not exceed \$200 in drawer."
- **Who Can Drop:** "Server performs drop when floor allows; manager on duty verifies next business day. If server cannot leave floor, notify manager for alternate plan."
- **Drop Method:** "Count cash, complete drop slip, place cash in deposit envelope, deposit into safe. Log drop in binder."
- **Drawer Retention:** "Maintain minimum change bank (\$80) in drawer. Any overage must be dropped."
- **Closing/Shift Change:** "At shift end, print X-report, count drawer with witness if available, note discrepancies immediately."

Handwritten Additions (Noted on Sheet)

- In the margin beside "top of each hour," a note reads: ***"If slammed, do next lull—DON'T leave counter empty."**
- Near the bottom, another note reads: ***"Back office key w/ day mgr (Ray). Ask if safe jams."**

Relevance to Incident Window

The incident occurred at **2026-05-11 03:18 (PT)**. Per the typed schedule, a cash drop is expected at **03:00** "when possible," implying cash may be present in the drawer if the floor is busy or the server is unable to step away.

Access / Knowledge Implications

The sheet indicates the routine is known to staff and that deviations are anticipated during busy periods, creating a predictable opportunity: if the 03:00 drop is delayed, the drawer may briefly exceed the intended limit. The handwritten note about the **back office key** suggests reliance on (and access by) the **day manager ("Ray")** for safe-related issues.

Procedural Control and Oversight

The instructions emphasize that the **manager verifies next business day**, reinforcing that management is expected to understand discrepancies and has visibility into when drops did or did not occur. This is consistent with the role of a day manager who reconciles prior-night activity.



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Chain of Custody (Initial)

Collected by responding investigator during the morning follow-up on **2026-05-11** after case opening. Document photographed in place, then removed and placed in an evidence sleeve.

Investigative Notes / Leads

- Compare the "top of the hour" expectation to the **POS transaction export (02:45–03:45)** and any **drop binder** entries (if located) to confirm whether a 03:00 drop occurred.
- Clarify who authored the handwritten note referencing **"day mgr (Ray)"** and when it was added.
- Determine whether staff were trained to contact the day manager for safe/key issues during overnight hours, which could explain knowledge of or access to back-of-house controls despite the manager not being scheduled onsite.

Limitations

This sheet reflects the **intended** routine rather than proof the routine was followed on the night of **2026-05-11**. It supports opportunity/knowledge analysis but requires corroboration with logs, receipts, and timestamped entries/exits.